

Privacy Choices

A privacy decision aid that asks what the student values **before** a service decides for them.

The problem I chose

Privacy policies disclose practices, but the work of interpreting them is left to the student. I wanted to connect those disclosures to five questions: what am I sharing, what am I unwilling to share, how is it handled, what can I change, and do I still want to use this service?

01 Choose

Select a service and local preferences.

02 Understand

Inspect conflicts and source evidence.

03 Reduce

Apply a control or review a guide.

04 Decide

Acknowledge what remains, or decline.

What I built

Privacy Choices Preferences saved locally

YOUR PRIVACY, YOUR CALL

Before you visit

Decide what you are comfortable sharing. Desktop browser only

1 Preferences 2 Findings 3 Reductions 4 Your decision

Choose a service

3 supported services

Service name or URL

Google Maps **Analyze policy** →

Google Maps Location Quizlet Tracking ChatGPT Data use Google Maps selected. No company page has been opened.

An access token is required for live analysis. [Configure access token](#)

Only the service ID goes to the analysis backend. Your preferences stay on this device.

Your preferences

LOCAL ONLY

Selected means acceptable to you, not permission granted to the service.

Information I can share

0 of 8 selected [None](#) [All](#)

- ☐ **Identity & contact details**
Name, email, account details
- ☐ **Browser location**
Location requested from this browser
- ☐ **Approximate location**
Area inferred from your IP address
- ☐ **Device & cookie identifiers**
Browser, device, and session identifiers

POLICY REVIEW

Not requested

No findings yet
No policy analysis has been received for this review.

Selected service	Google Maps
Acceptable information	0 of 8 types
Collection assessment	Not assessed

Actual extension interface. Preferences stay in the browser. The private backend receives only a supported service ID, not the original URL or preference selections.

Three services, three different privacy decisions

Google Maps

Block browser location; IP location and typed places remain.

Quizlet

Review optional tracking choices; do not promise to remove essential processing.

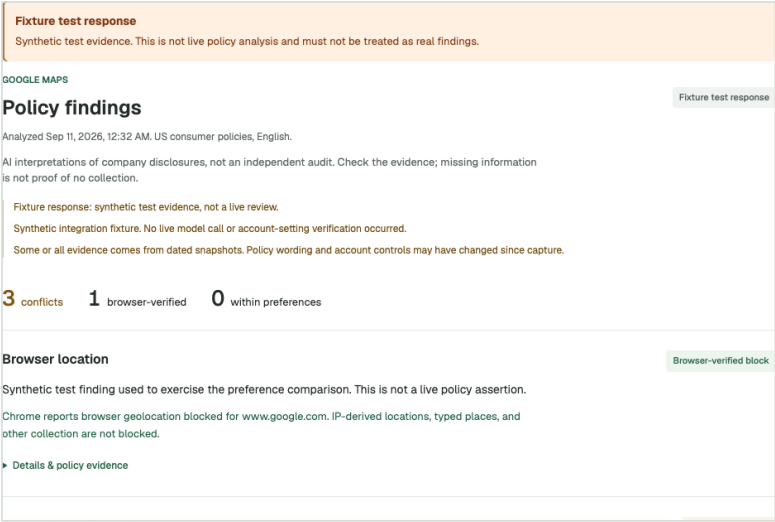
ChatGPT

Distinguish receiving a conversation from using it for model training.

The decisions behind it

Agency over a score	No universal safe/unsafe rating. The student chooses acceptable data and uses, then acknowledges unresolved risks.
Separate facts from protection	Company policy, AI interpretation, user-reported changes, and browser-verified controls are different states.
Live analysis with honest fallbacks	Fetch fixed official sources; use an anonymous reader or dated snapshot when blocked. Never interpret a CAPTCHA as policy.
Small and inspectable	Native extension UI, a small Node backend, and persistent budget reservations. No browsing-history access or autonomous account edits.

Verified behavior, not a blanket privacy guarantee



4 conflicts became 3. Chrome's actual location setting changed to Block. The synthetic IP-location, content, and activity findings stayed unresolved.

36 automated checks passed. Includes an isolated real-Redis test: 100 concurrent reservation attempts accepted 71 and reserved \$4.97, below the \$5 limit.

Evidence boundary. This is a real extension screenshot with visibly labeled synthetic policy responses. It proves the interaction and browser control, not live AI accuracy.

Feasibility and return on effort

Publicly accessible: policies and help pages about collection, purposes, retention, and controls. Five dated source snapshots were obtained. Latest retrieval used two direct sources, one reader, and two snapshots. **Not established:** internal processing, complete tracking prevention, account-specific choices, or semantic correctness of AI summaries.

Return: three bounded services make the preference-to-decision flow testable. Broader coverage would add recurring policy review and site-specific maintenance. The AI allowance is capped; no paid model call has been made. Educational usefulness is a hypothesis: no student usability study has been completed.

Current delivery status: extension ZIP built; backend deployed and authentication checked. Live analysis is not activated: OpenAI and Upstash credentials are still required. Guided account settings and real-model output remain unverified.

Sources and evidence: [Google privacy / location](#) | [Quizlet privacy](#) | [ChatGPT data controls](#) | [Chrome content settings](#)

Public policies were captured September 11, 2026 (UTC). Source details, test commands, and the remaining setup steps accompany the code in README.md and DECISIONS.md.